

Premiums would jump without ACA subsidies

Mass. connector gives consumers the bad news

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts has begun notifying people who receive health insurance through the Affordable Care Act's exchange how much their premiums would increase without the federal subsidies that are due to expire at the end of the year.

The state is among the first in the nation to provide specifics on how much more expensive insurance could become for the roughly 24 million people nationwide who rely on the exchanges for affordable health insurance.

In Massachusetts, some would see premium hikes of hundreds or thousands of dollars a year, according to the Massachusetts Health Connector, the state's version of the ACA. Others will see even steeper hikes if federal health subsidies expire at the end of the year.

With extension of the subsidies at the heart of the stalemate behind the government shutdown, specifics on the size of the premium increases could add new pressure on Congress.

The subsidies were introduced in an expansion of the ACA in 2021. Democratic leaders want to make the subsidies permanent, but Republicans have declined to consider that until Congress authorizes new funding to reopen the government. The expanded tax credits doubled

PREMIUMS, Page A10

Preservation of East Wing became demolition

Trump initially said it wouldn't be affected

By Luke Broadwater
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — As roaring machinery tore down one side of the White House, President Trump acknowledged Wednesday that he was having the entire East Wing demolished to make way for his 90,000-square-foot ballroom, a striking expansion of a project that is remaking the profile of one of the nation's most iconic buildings.

Trump was unsentimental as news of the demolition spread. "It was never thought of as being much," he said of the East Wing, which was home to the first lady's office and spaces used for ceremonial purposes. "It was a very small building."

The process of tearing down the East Wing was expected to be completed as soon as this weekend, two senior administration officials said, as Trump moved rapidly to carry out a passion project that he said was necessary to host state dinners and other events.

But the previously unannounced decision to demolish the East Wing was at odds with Trump's previous statements about the project,

WHITE HOUSE, Page A7

Aid programs for families at risk

SHUTDOWN
DAY 23

10
Failed Senate
votes

Sept. 19
Date of last
session

594,048
Workers
furloughed

35 days
Longest-ever
shutdown



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Jasarah Burgos of Springfield, shown with her 3-year-old son, Sebastian, said, "Not knowing what's going to happen keeps me up at night."

If shutdown continues, Head Start, heating aid, school lunches face cuts

By Katarina Schmeiszer
and Sadaf Tokhi

GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

Tens of thousands of Massachusetts families that depend on federally funded programs covering child care, heating bills, and school lunches are facing a potential loss of assistance if the government shutdown extends into November, according to state and local agencies.

The Massachusetts Home Energy Assistance Program helps

more than 150,000 low-income residents pay their heating bills every winter with a typical subsidy of up to \$600 per household, provided almost entirely with federal funding, starting on Nov. 1.

Six Head Start programs in the state providing education, health, and nutrition services to almost 3,000 young children rely mainly on annual federal grants awarded in October or November.

PROGRAMS, Page A6

DIWALI BLESSINGS



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

This week, millions of people around the world are marking Diwali, the five-day Festival of Lights. Young and old at Sri Lakshmi Temple in Ashland celebrated the triumph of good over evil and of positivity over negativity. **B4.**

Sununu takes his shot at Shaheen's seat

Will face Brown in battle for GOP nod

By Steven Porter
GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD, N.H. — John E. Sununu, a Republican former US senator from New Hampshire and brother of former governor Christopher T. Sununu, launched his campaign Wednesday in the race to succeed Democratic Senator Jeanne Shaheen, whose forthcoming retirement has set the stage for a wide-open 2026 contest with potential national implications.

John Sununu, who served one term before losing to Shaheen in

2008, said he wants to return to the Senate to help work through Washington's dysfunction.

"Somebody has to step up and lower the temperature," he said in a campaign launch video. "Somebody has to get things done."

Sununu's highly anticipated entry into the race could energize Republican hopes of reclaiming the seat, though he's not the only former senator seeking the GOP nomination.

Sununu, 61, is up against Scott Brown, 66, who represented Massachusetts in the Senate, later served as ambassador to New Zealand, and now lives in Rye, N.H.

Brown launched his campaign over the summer as the first Republi-

can candidate to enter the race. But polling conducted late last month by the University of New Hampshire Survey Center showed him trailing Sununu by a 23-point margin among likely GOP primary voters. A third Republican candidate, state Senator Daniel E. Innis, has already dropped out of the running and endorsed Sununu.

Sununu's family name represents a political dynasty in New Hampshire, where the list of past governors includes his younger brother Christopher and their father, John H. Sununu, who went on to serve as White House chief of staff for President George H.W. Bush.

SUNUNU, Page A7

A contract dispute between the state's largest insurer and Central Massachusetts' largest provider could disrupt the health care of approximately 185,000 people. D1.

Ex-WBZ-TV news anchor Kate Merrill has dropped claims against one defendant in her federal lawsuit alleging she was forced out of her job. B1.

Graham Platner, a Senate candidate in Maine, said a tattoo on his chest has been covered to no longer reflect an image that is widely recognized as a Nazi symbol. B1.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced new sanctions against Russia's two biggest oil companies. A3.



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

ROUGH START — Much has changed for the Celtics with the loss of the injured Jayson Tatum and others, and things will be different this season. It was apparent on opening night Wednesday at TD Garden, as Boston blew a 13-point fourth quarter lead and fell to the Sixers, 117-116. **C1.**

A difficult life with a horrific end leaves memories of happier times

Ex-nurse struggled with mental illness and homelessness

By Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

As a teenager in the early 1980s, Marie Molea was captain of the cheer-leading team and homecoming queen at Lynn Central High School.

She later got married and started a family. She went to college and became a school nurse. She ran the Boston Marathon. She doted on her children, cheering for them at sports games and Irish dance meets.

But everything changed when Molea started experiencing bouts of paranoia, leaving her family perplexed and concerned. She gradually became consumed by mental illness.

As her condition worsened and her physical health declined, Molea withdrew from the robust life she had built — a decades-long downward spiral that ultimately left her unhoused on the streets of Boston.

Last week, the family learned that Molea, 61, had been killed in a shooting not far from the women's shelter in Roxbury where she often stayed. Police have released few details, including whether they believe she was an intended target. No arrests have been made.

Officers found Molea lying face-down next to a bus shelter on Washington Street, according to a police report. She was later pronounced dead at the hospital.

It was a horrific ending to an already painful story.

"We knew we'd get a bad phone **VICTIM, Page A10**



Pumpkin it up

Thursday: Breezy, seasonable. High 59-64. Low 44-49.

Friday: More of the same. High 56-61. Low 41-46.

High tide: 12:56 a.m., 1 p.m.
Sunrise: 7:07 Sunset: 5:50

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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